

Stephanie Patterson

User Experience Researcher and Developer - Accessibility Specialist

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EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology

Master of Science in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)

Fall 2024 - Spring 2026

GPA: 4.0/4.0

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Linguistics

Fall 2020 - Spring 2024

GPA: 3.9/4.0

Minors: Disability Studies, Game Studies and Design

Relevant Coursework: Foundations of HCI, Research Methods, Information and Interaction Design, Usability Testing, Research in Accessibility, Accessible Web Resource Design, Access and Assistive Technology

SKILLS

Research Methods	Usability Testing, Interviews, Surveys, Co-Design, Qualitative/Quantitative Data Analysis
Programming	HTML, CSS, JavaScript, ARIA, C++, Python, Chuck, Java, Blueprint, Foma
Software Libraries	Python NLTK, Scikit-Learn, Pandas, NumPy, Parselmouth, BeautifulSoup, SQLite
Tools	Figma, FigJam, Qualtrics, WCAG, Git, Microsoft Excel, Praat, Unreal Engine
Languages	ASL (Working Proficiency), Spanish (Conversational), German (Basic)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant: Center for Accessibility and Inclusion Research

Aug 2025 - present

Rochester Institute of Technology

- Work directly with Dr. Kristen Shinohara on a variety of research tasks for her ongoing studies, including collecting and analyzing both qualitative and quantitative data
- Ongoing projects explore accessible research methods for Deaf and Hard of Hearing users, the effect of metacognitive beliefs on computing education, and applications for automatic ASL-English translation

Graduate Research Assistant: Accessible and Immersive Realities Lab

Nov 2024 - Aug 2025

Rochester Institute of Technology

- Design and implement an algorithm that encodes speech sounds as haptic signals on a wearable device for a user research study exploring ways to add emotional feedback to captioning
- Conducted user studies with Deaf and Hard of Hearing caption users in ASL as the sole moderator
- Presented about this work at Gallaudet University's *Deaf and Hard of Hearing Accessible Technology State of Science* conference, and submitted a CHI paper as co-first author

UX Research Assistant: FaMe Project

Jan 2024 - Aug 2024

University of Illinois - College of Applied Health Sciences

- Designed an interactive Figma prototype for a fall detection app for wheelchair or scooter users, and iteratively improved the prototype's UX in response to feedback from healthcare professionals and users
- Conducted user interviews with healthcare professionals and accessibility experts, updating the design to ensure compliance with expert advice and Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG)

Research Intern: Accessible Information and Communication Technologies

May 2023 - July 2023

Gallaudet University: NSF-Funded Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU)

- Project 1 - Designed and conducted a mixed-methods research study collecting survey feedback on a sign language archive interface, and iteratively improved a Figma prototype in response to users' values and priorities
- Project 2 - Researched AR and VR technology's potential to make communication more accessible for Deaf and Hard of Hearing individuals, employing a co-design methodology in interviews conducted in ASL
- Presented findings from both projects in both English and sign language to industry professionals and accessibility experts, as well as members of the Gallaudet community

PUBLICATIONS

Chen, Si, Haocong Cheng, Suzy Su, **Stephanie Patterson**, Raja Kushalnagar, Yun Huang, and Qi Wang. Customizing Generated Signs and Voices of AI Avatars: Deaf-Centric Mixed-Reality Design for Deaf-Hearing Communication. Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW '25).